ASCEND

Research & Company Outreach Orientation

Research → Identify Need → Find Contact → Reach Out → Collaborate

1. Purpose of ASCEND

- Bridge the gap between educational institutions, talent and growing companies.
- Help colleges improve placement outcomes through structured placement support.
- Help companies access job-ready, pre-trained and relevant talent.
- Connect company hiring requirements with suitable candidates from our institutional network.
- Core message: Empowering Students. Elevating Institutions. Connecting Growth.

2. What ASCEND Can Do for Companies

- Source candidates for open positions.
- Provide pre-screened and interview-ready freshers and junior talent.
- Support bulk hiring and recurring entry-level recruitment.
- Give companies access to talent from Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities.
- Reduce HR time spent on sourcing and initial screening.
- Provide CV building, interview preparation and role-specific training.
- Act as an extended recruitment / talent-acquisition partner.

3. What Is Our Research Job?

- Find companies that may need talent.
- Understand what the company does and which industry it operates in.
- Identify founders / decision-makers and HR / Talent Acquisition contacts.
- Find current vacancies and the roles the company is hiring for.
- Understand hiring demand and why ASCEND could be useful.
- Prepare accurate information so PR can contact the right person with the right pitch.

4. How to Research a Company

- STEP 1 — Search the company name and verify the official website.
- STEP 2 — Check industry, products/services, locations and company size.
- STEP 3 — Find founder/CEO and HR / Talent Acquisition decision-makers.
- STEP 4 — Check the Careers page, LinkedIn Jobs and reputable job portals.
- STEP 5 — Note open roles, locations, experience and skills required.
- STEP 6 — Identify the hiring opportunity for ASCEND.
- STEP 7 — Record sources and contact information.

5. Tools for Research

Use different tools for different stages of company research.

- Google / Bing — Find company websites, news, announcements, vacancies and other public information.
- LinkedIn — Find founders, HR / Talent Acquisition people, employees, company activity and job openings.
- Apollo — Research B2B companies and professional contacts; useful for finding decision-makers and building prospect lists.
- ContactOut — Find professional contact information such as work emails and phone numbers where available; verify important details before outreach.
- Official Company Website — Verify company profile, products/services, locations, leadership and official contact channels.
- Careers Page / Job Portals — Find current vacancies, hiring roles, locations, skills and experience requirements.
- Excel / Google Sheets / CRM — Store company research, contacts, vacancies, sources, status and follow-up actions.
- AI Tools — Summarize and organize research quickly; never treat AI output as proof—verify important facts with sources.

6. What Information Should We Collect?

- Company name + official website
- Industry + products/services
- Location + approximate company size
- Founder / CEO name
- HR / Talent Acquisition name and designation
- Official company email / phone and legitimate public professional contacts
- Current vacancies + hiring roles
- Hiring locations + skills / experience
- Hiring demand / growth signals
- How ASCEND can help + source + date checked

7. From Research to Outreach

- Do not contact a company with a generic message.
- First identify the specific hiring need.
- Find the most relevant decision-maker.
- Prepare a short, company-specific reason for contacting them.
- Example: “You are currently hiring for multiple BDE roles. ASCEND can provide pre-screened, interview-ready candidates from our institutional network.”
- Choose the best route: cold call, cold email or LinkedIn outreach.

8. Cold Calling — Simple Structure

- 1. Introduction: “Hello, I’m [Name] from ASCEND.”
- 2. Reason: “We support companies with hiring and job-ready talent.”
- 3. Research insight: mention one real hiring signal or role.
- 4. Value: explain how ASCEND can support that requirement.
- 5. Ask: “Could I speak with the person handling recruitment / HR?”
- 6. If interested: request a short meeting or permission to send the company deck.
- Keep the call short, professional and focused on the company’s need.

9. Cold Email — Simple Structure

- Subject: Talent Support for [Company Name]
- Start with one personalized observation about their hiring.
- Briefly introduce ASCEND.
- Explain the relevant value: sourcing + screening + candidate readiness.
- Ask for a short discussion about current or upcoming hiring needs.
- Keep it concise — avoid long company descriptions.
- Use accurate contact details and never make unsupported claims.

10. Research & Outreach Golden Rules

- Accuracy > quantity.
- Use recent and reliable sources.
- Never guess contact details or vacancies.
- Separate facts from assumptions.
- Always record where important information came from.
- Research with one question: “How can ASCEND help this company?”
- Your research is successful when PR knows WHO to contact, WHY to contact them and WHAT to offer.

11. Complete ASCEND Workflow

- TARGET COMPANY
- ↓
- RESEARCH COMPANY
- ↓
- IDENTIFY HIRING NEED
- ↓
- FIND HR / DECISION-MAKER
- ↓
- PREPARE PERSONALIZED PITCH
- ↓
- COLD CALL / COLD EMAIL / LINKEDIN
- ↓
- MEETING → HIRING REQUIREMENT → CANDIDATES → PLACEMENT

12. Final Takeaway

- Research is not about collecting everything.
- It is about finding a real business opportunity.
- Know the company.
- Know what they are hiring.
- Know who handles hiring.
- Know how ASCEND can help.
- Then reach out with a relevant and professional message.